

LEDGER & CO. — MEMBER GUIDE

The Yield Map

June 2026 Edition

Where the real interest is this month, what each rate actually requires, and how to tell a genuine high-yield account from a marketing headline.

PREPARED FOR: [MEMBER NAME / EMAIL]

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Where Things Stand Right Now

The Federal Reserve has held its benchmark federal funds rate steady at 3.50%–3.75% through the first half of 2026, after three rate cuts in late 2025. That pause means savings and CD rates have mostly stabilized too — drifting down slightly, but nowhere near a cliff. The takeaway: the accounts below are still paying meaningfully more than a typical bank, and there's no obvious reason to wait for a "better moment" to move your cash.

For context: the FDIC's published national average savings rate is just 0.38% APY. Every account in this guide pays at least 8–13x that. If your money is sitting in a traditional bank's default savings account, this is the single highest-leverage 15-minute task in your financial life this month.

This Month's Top Verified High-Yield Savings Accounts

Ranked by real-world usability — APY, fees, and how easy the rate actually is to qualify for — not just the biggest headline number.

Account	APY	What You Need to Know
Varo Bank Savings	5.00%	Highest rate on this list, but capped at a \$5,000 balance and requires a qualifying direct deposit. Above \$5,000, the excess typically earns a much lower rate.
Axos One	4.21%	"Boosted" rate requires meeting specific deposit and balance conditions — read Axos's current terms before assuming you'll get the top number.
Pibank Savings	4.40%	No minimum deposit, no monthly fee, full rate regardless of balance. App ratings and transfer options are limited — fine as a pure savings account, less fine as your primary bank.
Climate First Bank	4.01%	Minimal minimum deposit requirements; a solid, no-strings option if you don't want to chase a promo rate.
CIT Platinum Savings	3.75%–4.10%	Tiered: full rate requires a \$5,000+ balance. Below that, you earn a much lower base rate (around 0.25%) — read this one carefully.
American Express HYSAs	~3.6%–3.8%	No minimum deposit or balance requirement to earn the full advertised rate — a genuinely no-catch option from a major, recognizable institution.
Western Alliance Bank (via Raisin)	3.80%	Flat rate, no tiers — but this is a limited-time promotional offer through Raisin. Confirm the current end date before counting on it long-term.

SOURCES: BANKRATE, NERDWALLET, FORTUNE (CURINOS DATA), THE MOTLEY FOOL, WALLETHUB — ALL VERIFIED JUNE 17, 2026. RATES ARE VARIABLE AND CAN CHANGE WITHOUT NOTICE. CONFIRM CURRENT TERMS DIRECTLY ON THE ISSUER'S SITE BEFORE OPENING ANY ACCOUNT.

The Fee & Minimum-Balance Traps (Read This Before You Apply)

Almost every "top APY" headline has an asterisk. Here are the three patterns that show up over and over:

1. The Balance Cap

Varo's 5.00% sounds like the obvious winner — until you realize it only applies up to \$5,000. If you're depositing \$20,000, the blended effective rate on that account is much lower than 5.00%, because everything above the cap earns far less. Always ask: "what does my *fifteenth* thousand dollars earn here?"

2. The Tiered Minimum

CIT Platinum Savings is the clearest example: \$5,000+ gets you a strong rate; anything less gets you roughly 0.25% — barely better than a traditional bank. If you're not consistently going to hold the minimum, a flat-rate account (like Pibank or American Express) is usually the better real-world choice, even if its top-line number is slightly lower.

3. The Disappearing Promo

Western Alliance's 3.80% through Raisin, and various "boosted rate" offers, are time-limited. They're genuinely good while they last — just calendar the end date the moment you open the account, so you're not surprised when it quietly reverts to a lower standard rate.

The one-question test: before opening any account from a "top rate" list, ask: "Is this rate guaranteed for my actual balance, indefinitely, or is there a number or a date where it changes?" If you can't answer that from the page you're looking at, you haven't found the real terms yet — keep digging on the issuer's own site.

CDs: When They Beat a Savings Account

With the Fed on pause, top CD rates are currently running close to — and in some terms, ahead of — the best savings accounts, which is a meaningfully different situation than a year or two ago. The trade-off is simple: you lock up access to the money for the CD's term, and in exchange you usually get rate certainty a variable-rate savings account can't offer.

Term	Approx. Top APY	Notes
3-12 month	3.50%–4.15%	Popular Direct's 1-year CD led recent listings at 4.15%; short terms currently carry the highest rates of any CD length.
1-year	~4.10%–4.15%	E*TRADE's 1-year CD (4.10%, no minimum deposit) is a strong, low-barrier option from a major institution.
3-year	~3.60%–4.15%	TAB Bank has run near the top of this term at points this year.
5-year	up to ~4.30%	Longer terms occasionally edge out shorter ones when a bank wants to lock in deposits — check both ends before assuming "longer = lower."

SOURCES: BANKRATE, NERDWALLET, FORTUNE (CURINOS DATA), WALLETHUB, SMARTASSET — VERIFIED JUNE 2026. CD RATES SHOWN ARE TOP-OF-MARKET EXAMPLES, NOT GUARANTEED AVAILABLE RATES; YOUR ACTUAL OFFER DEPENDS ON THE ISSUER, TERM, AND TIMING OF YOUR APPLICATION.

Important on inflation: the Consumer Price Index rose to 3.8% annually as of the most recent reading. If your CD's APY is below that, you're technically losing purchasing power even while "earning interest" — still worth doing for safety and certainty, just worth knowing going in.

A Simple Way to Decide Between Savings and a CD

- ☑ If you might need the money in the next 0-6 months: stick with a high-yield savings account. Don't lock it up.
- ☑ If you know you won't touch it for 12+ months: a CD at today's rates is worth comparing against your savings account's rate.
- ☑ If you're not sure: split it. Keep an emergency-fund portion liquid in savings, and ladder the rest across CD terms — see the Income-Layering Worksheet in The Annotated Portfolio for a structured way to do this with your own numbers.

Before You Open Anything: The FDIC/NCUA Check

Every account in this guide should be FDIC-insured (banks) or NCUA-insured (credit unions) up to \$250,000 per depositor, per institution. This is non-negotiable for where you keep meaningful savings. Two ways to verify in under a minute:

- ☑ Search the institution name directly on the FDIC's BankFind tool (fdic.gov) or the NCUA's Credit Union Locator

(ncua.gov).

- ☑ Look for the official FDIC or NCUA badge on the account's own application page — not just a logo in a footer, but a direct statement of insured status.

If you can't confirm insured status in those places, that's a reason to stop and ask questions before depositing anything — regardless of how good the advertised rate looks.

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